

Think light

IBM India has announced new notebooks, with select models including Intel's just-launched Centrino mobile technology, which provide wireless connectivity while helping to deliver high performance and extended battery life. A full 30 per cent thinner than its T30 predecessor, the ThinkPad T40 has a travel weight of just over 2 Kg and measures about an inch thin.



The latest IBM Notebook

The ThinkPad X31 is approximately 1-inch thin, weighs 1.5 Kg, and at up to six hours, claims to have the longest system battery life in the industry.

All three models—the ThinkPad T40, X31 and R40—feature select models that are equipped with IBM's Embedded Security Subsystem (ESS). This is an IBM ThinkVantage Technology that combines hardware and downloadable software to authenticate users, and help protect data and private information in both wired and wireless communications environments.

The new notebooks will be available from 5 April, 2003. The ThinkPad T40 notebooks will cost Rs 1,99,900, while the ThinkPad R40e start at a price of Rs 1,39,900, while the ThinkPad X31 will be priced at Rs 1,49,900—all prices excluding taxes.

snapshot

The average e-mail account received **2,200** spam messages last year

Source: Jupiter Research

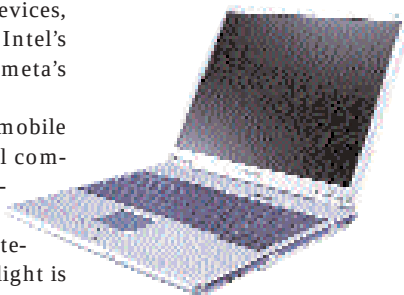
Notebooks chip merrily

The thin-and-light notebook space is becoming increasingly claustrophobic, with AMD having announced a new line-up of devices, close on the heels of Intel's Centrino and Transmeta's Astro offerings.

Unveiling 12 new mobile chips, five of them will compete in the thin-and-light segment; the rest will go into the full notebook space. Thin-and-light is defined as devices that are about an inch in height and weigh less than 2 Kg.

AMD is announcing five low-voltage Mobile Athlon XP-M chips for this space—the 1400+, 1500+, 1600+, 1700+ and 1800+. The processor frequencies range from 1.2 GHz to 1.5 GHz, with a peak power of 25 watts. They also offer 384 KB of combined Level 1 and Level 2 on-chip cache. In the full notebook space, AMD is offering four new Athlon XP-M chips based on the compa-

ny's Thoroughbred core—the 2000+, 2200+, 2400+ and 2600+—and three others—the 2200+, 2400+ and



The new AMD processor is designed to power thin notebooks

2500+—based on its Barton core. These chips range in frequency from 1.67 GHz to 2.13 GHz.

While chips with the Thoroughbred core offer 384 KB, the Barton core comes with 640 KB of combined cache. Larger on-die caches allow faster data access. Products from OEMs, including HP and Epson Direct, are expected to arrive using these solutions.

Movies on the go

Benq, the Taiwanese electronics maker, plans to incorporate the new Media2Go OS on a portable device that is half cellphone and half-digital audio-video player. The device will showcase multimedia, such as pictures, audio and movies, using MPEG-4 formats. The device will incorporate 10 to 20 GB of storage in the form of a 1.8-inch hard disk, made by either Hitachi or Toshiba.

MPEG-4 is the next-generation, global multimedia standard, delivering professional-quality audio and video streams over a wide range of bandwidths. MPEG-

4 was defined by the Moving Picture Experts Group, the working group within the International Organisation for Standardisation (ISO) that specified the widely adopted, MPEG-1 and MPEG-2 standards. Hundreds of researchers around the world contributed to MPEG-4, which was finalised in 1998 and became an international standard in 2000.

Media2Go is based on Windows CE, and provides complete support for a broad range of media formats, including Windows Media Audio, Windows Media Video and MP3.

heroes

Anti-spam movement Yahoo!, Dell Computer, Oracle, Microsoft, Sun Microsystems and AOL Time Warner, gathered, to talk about the problem that unsolicited bulk email has created for legitimate marketers, technology developers, ISPs and their customers. The goal of the forum, called JamSpam, is to produce an open, interoperable anti-spam specification that serves as a universal solution to both edges of the spam sword.

... more action The Anti-Spam Research Group too is exploring fundamental changes in the Internet architecture to eradicate spam. It suggested that the SMTP should be replaced, to adjust to other Internet standards in order to stymie unsolicited mass-mailings.

zeroes

U.S military Some units of the U.S military are clamping down on email from their soldiers and sailors, situated in the Persian Gulf. Computer security experts opine that the enemy would not devote much attention to hacking into email from the troops. The military's sensitive operational information is kept on a proprietary network, called the Secret Internet Protocol Network that is not connected to the Internet.

Macromedia's new Web site

Macromedia's redesigned Web site does not work with some browsers, such as Safari and Opera. The redesign uses sophisticated animation to navigate menus and other tasks. Macromedia said the site works with those browsers (but very slowly), which represent less than 5 per cent of traffic.